



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Medicine in the 21st century



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can write about technology and subjects of study.
- I can organize points in an argument.
- I can express possibility and certainty.

Ask your partner:

- How do you think medicine has changed in the last 50 years?
- Do you think that robots have a place in medicine? What could they do?

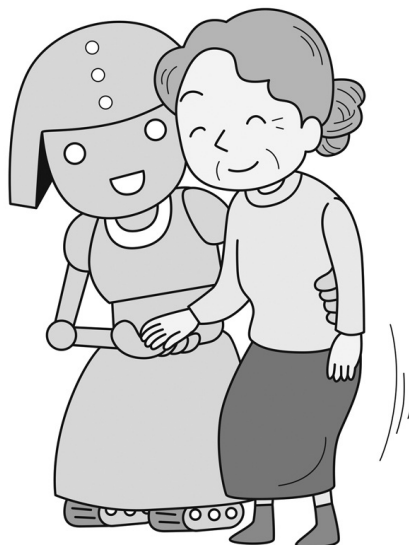




Let's Explore!

Technology is **transforming*** all parts of society, including medicine.

* To "*transform*" means to change something completely and usually in a good way.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Although robots used to be the domain of science fiction novels and movies, they are now increasingly being used in mainstream society. Tasks that were previously reserved for humans, can now be performed by intelligent robots. The healthcare field is one of the major areas of human interest for robotics experts.

Robots have an advantage in performing surgery because they are extremely precise, and, often, make fewer mistakes than a human surgeon. In addition, they can reach areas that a surgeon would not be able to get to easily, and they have three-dimensional magnification. They have been employed in cardiac surgery, gastrointestinal surgery, gynecological procedures, and neurosurgery. The use of robots to assist the elderly may be one way of providing physical and emotional care to these patients. Besides needing physical help, aged patients often become lonely and withdrawn. Because many elderly people might be unable to care for a pet or live in a home that does not allow pets, some scientists are asking if a robotic pet could provide the same benefits.

Another key application of robots in medicine is in the pharmaceutical industry. In fact, automated robots can fill a prescription in 10 seconds, and are extremely accurate. In addition, the kinds of errors involved in reading handwriting must have been reduced by automation. Indeed, robots could play an important role in many areas of society. In the medical industry, the advent of these intelligent machines will continue to improve the quality of people's lives.





Let's Practice!

Robots in medicine are the way of the future.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Select the correct option to complete the sentence. Use the options from the box below.

- could play • could provide • might be unable • may be • mustn't

1. Robots _____ an important role in many areas of society.
2. For example, the use of robots to assist the elderly _____ one way of providing physical and emotional care to these patients.
3. Because many elderly people _____ to care for a pet or live in a home that does not allow pets, some scientists are asking if a robotic pet _____ the same benefits.
4. We _____ completely change our approach to health care.



Let's Practice!

Now, it's time to write about technology.

Instructions: Write a 80-100 word paragraph about a piece of technology you use that was not available 15-20 years ago, like an iPad. Include a topic sentence, supporting sentences and a concluding sentence. Write about what the technology is, how it is used and how it has changed the way we do things. Organize your paragraph by including linking words like in addition, also and in fact. Include expressions of possibility like might, may and could.

1. Technology:

2. Paragraph:





Extension Activity

Let's find out more about technology in the healthcare system.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Research other technological advances in the medical field.
- Choose one piece of technology that has improved the healthcare system.
- Write a paragraph that includes a topic sentence, supporting sentences and a concluding sentence about the technology.
- Include expressions of possibility and certainty.
- Proofread your paragraph.
- Read your paragraph to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research technological advances in the medical field.

☐ ☐

I write a paragraph about medical improvements.

☐ ☐

I proofread my paragraph about technology and read it to my partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **mainstream** (noun): the thoughts, beliefs, and choices that are accepted by the largest number of people
e.g. They are now increasingly being used in mainstream society.
- **advent** (noun): the time when something begins or arrives
e.g. In the medical industry, the advent of these intelligent machines will continue to improve the quality of people's lives.
- **precise** (adjective): very accurate and exact
e.g. Robots have an advantage in performing surgery because they are extremely precise, and, often, make fewer mistakes than a human surgeon.
- **magnification** (noun): the act of making something look larger than it is
e.g. They can reach areas that a surgeon would not be able to get to easily, and they have three-dimensional magnification.
- **pharmaceutical** (adjective): of or relating to the production and sale of drugs and medicine
e.g. Another key application of robots in medicine is in the pharmaceutical industry.
- **automated** (adjective): operated through the use of machines
e.g. In fact, automated robots can fill a prescription in 10 seconds.
- **gastrointestinal** (adjective): of or relating to both the stomach and the intestines
e.g. I have been having problems with my gastrointestinal tract.
- **gynecological** (adjective): of or relating to the scientific study of the female reproductive system and its diseases
e.g. My mother needed to have a gynecological procedure done in hospital.
- **cardiac** (adjective): of or relating to the heart
e.g. They have been employed in cardiac surgery.
- **neurosurgery** (noun): surgery on the brain
e.g. Robots are used in neurosurgery.



Learning Points

Organizing Points in an Argument

You use linking words to help you organize what you have written in a text. They also help you introduce and develop essential ideas.

Linking words help you to connect ideas and sentences, so that people can follow your ideas.

Here are some examples:

- *On the other hand*
- *In fact*
- *Of course*
- *In addition*
- *Indeed*

Examples:

- *Another key application of robots in medicine is in the pharmaceutical industry.*
- *In fact, automated robots can fill a prescription in 10 seconds, and are extremely accurate.*
- *In addition, the kinds of errors involved in reading handwriting must have been reduced by automation.*
- *Indeed, robots could play an important role in many areas of society.*





Learning Points

Modals for Possibility and Certainty

You can use modals to talk about degrees of certainty.

You use them to describe what is definite, probable, possible, or impossible from the speaker's point of view.

You can use *must*, *may*, *might*, and *could* to describe degrees of certainty.

Must = it's very likely

Must not / Could not / Can't = it's not possible

May / Might / Can / Could = it's possible

May not / Might not = it's possible this is not true

Examples:

- Robots **could** play an important role in many areas of society.
- Because many elderly people **might** be unable to care for a pet or live in a home that does not allow pets, some scientists are asking if a robotic pet **could** provide the same benefits.
- The use of robots to assist the elderly **may** be one way of providing physical and emotional care to these patients.
- We **mustn't** completely change our approach to health care.
- In addition, the kinds of errors involved in reading handwriting **must have been** reduced by automation.

